

Theory of rural and urban society:

“Ibn-i-Khaldun” believed that, human society differs from animal society. It supersedes the animal society because of the following traits.

- 1) human are endowed with wisdom
- 2) Human beings need a leader to look after their wellbeing and guide them through difficult situations.
- 3) Human beings always search the means of livelihood.
- 4) They live together, coordinate and cooperate, which lead towards the creation, of state.

However, mentioned traits lack in animals.

“Ibn I Khaldun” has described two types of societies in his book “*Badvi*” and “*Hazri*”.

According to his theory “Badvi” is rural society.

“Hazri” is urban society.

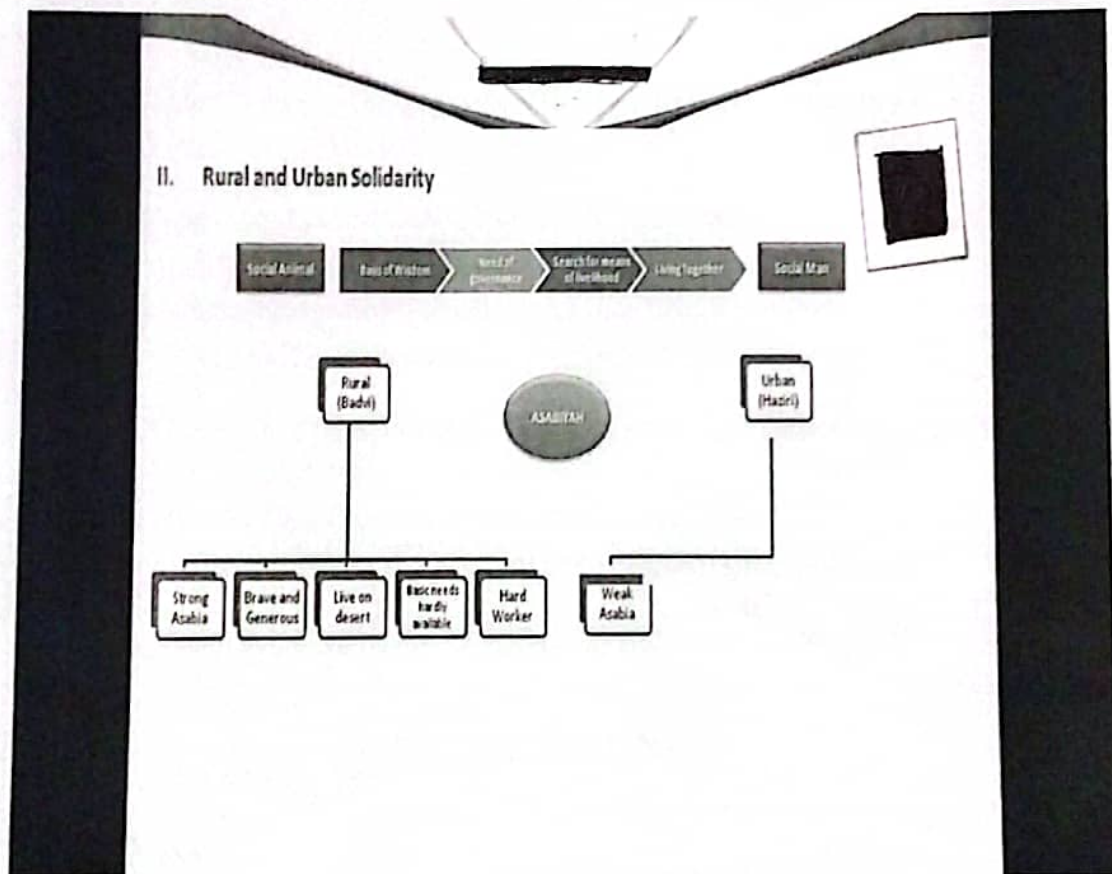
Badvi:

Individuals living in Badvi society are united and have strong force of Al-Asabiya. They have robust physical structure; live in deserts where satisfying basic needs are quite difficult. However, they have to struggle hard for their survival, therefore, they are physically strong. The traits and description provided by “Ibn-I-Khaldun” of the individuals, living in Badvi society, are similar to those people who live in villages and small valleys or rural areas. The tribes live a life which is of nomadic type. In this type of society group life found at the highest.

Hazri:

On the other hand, people living in “Hazri” society are described; similar to those people, who live in urban society. They are unlike the people of “Badvi”

society. They cannot defend them self against, external aggression; individuals of "Badvi" society are dependent on state security. They are not physically strong for the reason that, basic needs of life are easily available to them. In Hazri society, individuals do not have to struggle hard for their survival. The group life is weak. According to Khaldun this is called urban life.



IBN KHALDUN'S CYCLICAL THEORY:

Ibn Khaldun created the science of civilization, society or culture ('Ilmu al-'Imran or Imran) in order to define and analyze the history of human beings. To make the science functional, he uses Asabiya which is considered as group feeling, esprit de corps, and a kind of the spirit which boosts the bonds among people. This cohesion makes the group stronger and the asabiyya's main aim is to create a state. Therefore, the strength of Asabiya plays a determining role in the rise and fall of sovereign powers.

History is a cyclical process in which sovereign powers come to existence, get stronger, lose power and are collapsed by another power. The main item which

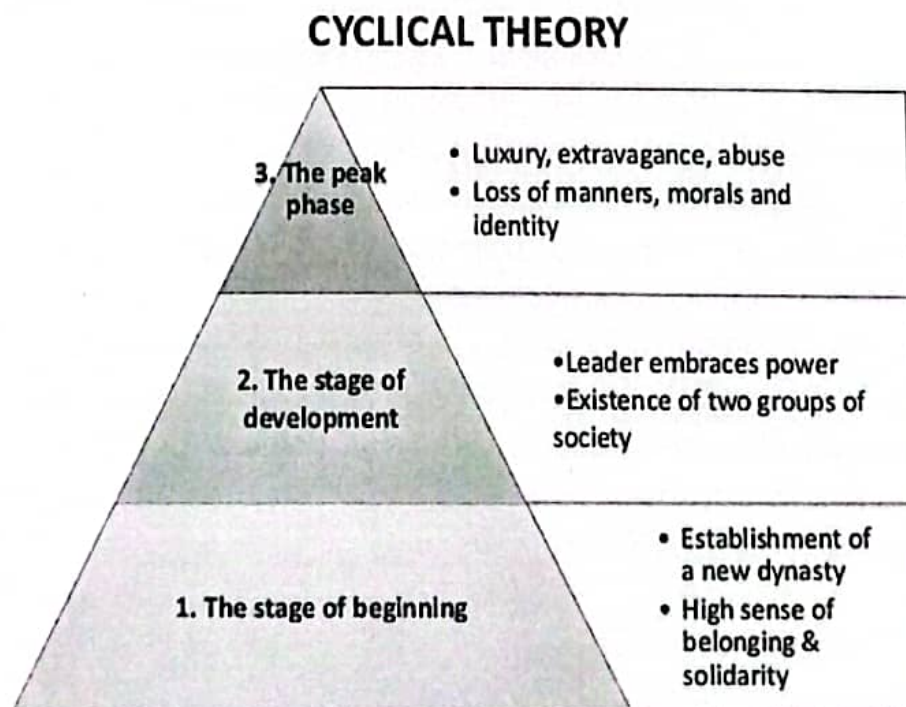
controls all the process is the condition of Asabiya. Primitive people are the origin of the society and have the strong Asabiya. This society is uncivilized and just struggles for immediate needs. In order to defend themselves from dangers coming from environment, animals or other humans, they have to improve themselves as strong warriors and they need to learn to survive even in the hardest conditions. Also, they have the strong relations with relatives and close friends.

When people develop, people start civilizing and losing these features which they have in the primitive life.

Sovereign powers have about 120-year life spans which take three or four generations. The reason for this is that over time, generations change and when the time passes, the coming generations forget about the previous generations' motivations and values gradually.

- 1) Fundamental principles and values of sovereign powers are established by first generations.
- 2) The second generations just follow former.
- 3) The third generations forget all the values of their ancestors.

The last generations cause the sovereign powers to collapse.



But the sovereign powers may continue to live more if the reasons which destroy the states do not take place in 120-year life spans. Also, Ibn Khaldun explained periods or stages which sovereign powers experience in their life spans

Five general historical stages of Ibn Khaldun on the rise and fall of sovereign powers Subject Features

- 1) The Foundation Stage of success, strong Asabiya, bond of lineage, uncivilized society, high chivalry, competent fighters, the importance of dignity and pride, unworthy of wealthy, a leader which is the first among equals and with limited power, heroism, high loyalty to leader, the strong obedience to tradition and religion, badawa period (rural life), taking the full control of subjects and the obedience of subjects, starting collecting tax, sending envoys to other states, defending its own borders (soldier superiority), no stronger power in its own land.
- 2) The personalization of power a leader with absolute power, the beginning of Asabiya of reason, professional army, the desire of individual loyalty just for a leader.
- 3) The growth and expansion (Leisure and tranquility time) Leisure and tranquility, big achievements in architecture, literature, science and art, the beginning of hazara (urban life), no threat from outside or inside, wealthy state, tax and agricultural regulations, new laws, the beginning of luxury life, the strongest level of the state, supporting arts and science and crafts, artistic development, sharing the money with subjects, the efforts to flourish a state, strong economy, general welfare.
- 4) Stagnation (Satisfaction and peacefulness time) Satisfaction and peacefulness, the leaders desiring to imitate their ancestors' actions, longing for the past, inexperienced leaders with weak characters, incompetent bureaucracy, the desire of luxury, lack of courage, unwillingness to war, comfortable life, lavish lifestyle, money desire, reached natural borders, bad habits.
- 5) The decline and dissolution (Waste and squandering time) Waste and squandering, a state with senility disease, lack of money, unfaithful soldiers, unmoral lifestyle, imitating stronger states, blaming for

ancestors' actions, lack of stronger Asabiya to keep a state under control and to defend.

Theory of religion:

According to Ibn-i-Khaldun, religion is both a sociological and spiritual experience. It is a source of purification of human mind and soul as well as a bond of social unity. Religion not only helps a man to face everyday life situation but also to face the misfortunes of life boldly and also a powerful instrument of socialization.

He concludes that both religion and asabiya suffer decay due to material prosperity and love of luxury. He considers religion as a lever of social injustices, at the same time it removes all evils. It helps in maintenance of unity and cooperation in all sections of society.

Criticism:

Ibn Khaldun is often criticized as "idle superstition and uncritical acceptance of historical data". As a result, he introduced a scientific method to the study of history, which was considered something "new to his age", and he often referred to it as his "new science", now associated with historiography.

It is generally remarked that Ibn-i-Khaldun's theory of rise and fall of nations is over-simplified.